JESUS CITY INTERNATIONAL MINISTRIES

THE BEREAN CHURCH — DEPARTMENTAL ARCHITECTURE & OPERATIONS BLUEPRINT

"Year of Establishment 2026" | Target: 500+ Members by December 2026

THE GROUND REALITY

JCIM is in startup mode. No operational departments. No structured systems. Leadership lacks clear role definitions. Ministry activities are funded personally by the General Overseer. Discipleship retention needs a structured system. The growth target is aggressive but achievable: 500+ committed members by December 2026.

This document builds the entire operational infrastructure from the ground up — departments, roles, phasing, and the systems that connect them.

PART ONE: THE DEPARTMENTAL ARCHITECTURE

Organizing Principle

Not every function needs its own department. At your current stage, you need **lean, high-impact departments** that can expand as you grow. The structure below uses **7 Core Departments**, each containing **sub-units** that can eventually become standalone departments as the church scales.

Think of it like this: Christ Embassy didn't start with 40 departments. They started with a few essential ones and multiplied structure as they multiplied people. Oyedepo's Winners Chapel runs on clear departmental lanes — but those lanes were built progressively.

THE 7 CORE DEPARTMENTS + SUB-UNITS

DEPARTMENT 1: SECRETARIAT & ADMINISTRATION

"The Nerve Center"

Scripture Foundation: "*Write the vision, and make it plain upon tables, that he may run that readeth it*." — Habakkuk 2:2

Why This Exists: Nothing functions without administration. This is the backbone that holds everything together. Every report, every record, every communication flows through here.

Department Head Title: Chief Administrative Secretary

Core Functions:

- Church records and documentation management
- Correspondence (internal and external)
- Meeting coordination and minutes
- Policy documentation and compliance
- General Overseer's office support
- Inter-departmental coordination

Sub-Units:

1a. Database & Information Management

- Membership database (names, contacts, salvation dates, baptism records, cell group, department, Foundation School progress)
- Attendance tracking systems
- Visitor/first-timer records
- Digital record-keeping and backup
- Data reporting and analytics

1b. Communications

- Official announcements (Sunday, midweek, digital)
- Internal newsletters
- External correspondence
- WhatsApp/Telegram group management and protocols
- Bulletin and program design

Immediate Priority Tools:

- Google Workspace or Microsoft 365 for shared documents
- A church management software (ChurchCenter, Breeze, or a simple Google Sheets system to start)
- Centralized WhatsApp broadcast list

Minimum Staffing to Launch: 1 Department Head + 1 Database Officer + 1 Communications Officer

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DEPARTMENT 2: FINANCE & STEWARDSHIP

"The Treasury"

Scripture Foundation: "*Moreover it is required in stewards, that a man be found faithful*." — 1 Corinthians 4:2

Why This Exists: The General Overseer must stop being the personal ATM of the ministry. This department creates financial systems that make the church self-sustaining, transparent, and positioned for growth.

Department Head Title: Financial Secretary / Chief Steward

Core Functions:

- Income collection and recording (tithes, offerings, first fruits, seeds, special collections)
- Expense management and disbursement
- Budget preparation and monitoring
- Financial reporting (weekly, monthly, quarterly)
- Bank account management
- Audit preparation

Sub-Units:

2a. Offering & Collections Team

- Sunday offering coordination
- Online giving setup and management
- Special project collections
- Partnership program administration

2b. Ministry Materials & Procurement

- Purchase of ministry supplies (communion elements, stationery, equipment)
- Inventory management
- Vendor relationships
- Asset register

2c. Covenant Wealth & Stewardship Teaching

- Financial literacy integration into discipleship
- Teaching series on biblical stewardship
- Testimony documentation (financial breakthroughs)

Critical First Actions:

1. Open a dedicated church bank account IMMEDIATELY (separate from personal funds)
2. Appoint a Financial Secretary and a Treasurer (two separate people — segregation of duties)
3. Create a simple income/expense tracking spreadsheet
4. Establish a weekly counting protocol: at least 2 people count offerings together, record, and deposit within 48 hours

5. Set a preliminary monthly budget
6. Introduce a giving culture through teaching (not just asking)

Revenue Independence Plan:

- Month 1-3: Transition from personal funding to congregational support
- Month 4-6: Establish regular tithe/offering baseline
- Month 7-12: Introduce partnership programs, project giving, and seed-faith campaigns
- Target: 70% congregational funding by Q3 2026, 90% by Q4 2026

Minimum Staffing to Launch: 1 Financial Secretary + 1 Treasurer + 2 Offering Collectors

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DEPARTMENT 3: WORSHIP, MUSIC & ARTS

"The Atmosphere Architects"

Scripture Foundation: "*But the hour cometh, and now is, when the true worshippers shall worship the Father in spirit and in truth*." — John 4:23

Why This Exists: The worship experience is the first thing visitors feel and the last thing members remember. This department creates an atmosphere where the Holy Spirit is welcome and encounters happen.

Department Head Title: Worship Director / Chief Musician

Core Functions:

- Sunday and midweek worship leading
- Song selection and arrangement
- Musician and vocalist coordination
- Sound and instrument management
- Worship rehearsal scheduling
- Special music events (praise nights, concerts)

Sub-Units:

3a. Music Ministry

- Choir/praise team
- Instrumentalists
- Song writing and original compositions
- Music training for new members

3b. Creative Arts

- Drama and spoken word

- Dance ministry
- Visual arts (stage design, backdrop creation)
- Creative content for special services

3c. Sound & Technical

- Sound system operation
- Audio mixing for live services
- Equipment maintenance
- Recording of services (audio)

Minimum Staffing to Launch: 1 Worship Leader + 2-3 Singers + 1 Instrumentalist (keyboard minimum) + 1 Sound Operator

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DEPARTMENT 4: MEDIA & PRODUCTION

"The Amplifiers"

Scripture Foundation: "*Go ye into all the world, and preach the gospel to every creature*." — Mark 16:15

Why This Exists: In the Christ Embassy model, media IS the ministry. Every sermon, every testimony, every event should be captured, packaged, and distributed. Media is your multiplication engine — it reaches people your physical building never will.

Department Head Title: Media Director

Core Functions:

- Service photography and videography
- Social media management (content creation, scheduling, engagement)
- Live streaming coordination
- Graphic design (flyers, banners, social media posts)
- Website management
- Sermon content repurposing

Sub-Units:

4a. Visual Media (Photo & Video)

- Service documentation
- Event coverage
- Testimonial recording
- Short-form content creation (Reels, TikTok, Shorts)

4b. Digital & Social Media

- Platform management (Instagram, Facebook, YouTube, TikTok, X)
- Content calendar execution
- Community engagement and response
- Analytics and growth tracking

4c. Design & Branding

- Graphic design for all ministry materials
- Brand identity enforcement
- Print materials (bulletins, banners, tracts)
- Merchandise design (when applicable)

4d. Publishing

- Book production support (for My Lord's publications)
- Devotional distribution
- Teaching materials design and printing
- Bookstore/resource center management

Sermon-to-Content Pipeline (Implement Immediately): Every Sunday sermon should produce:

1. Full-length video (YouTube)
2. Full-length audio (Podcast)
3. 3-5 short video clips (Social media — under 60 seconds each)
4. 5-10 quote graphics (Instagram/Facebook)
5. Blog post or written summary
6. Cell group discussion guide derived from the sermon

Minimum Staffing to Launch: 1 Media Director + 1 Photographer/Videographer + 1 Graphic Designer + 1 Social Media Manager

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DEPARTMENT 5: HOSPITALITY, PROTOCOL & EVENTS

"The First Impression Team"

Scripture Foundation: "*Be not forgetful to entertain strangers: for thereby some have entertained angels unawares*." — Hebrews 13:2

Why This Exists: A visitor decides within the first 7 minutes whether they will return. This department owns those 7 minutes — and everything that makes a service run smoothly from arrival to departure.

Department Head Title: Chief of Protocol / Hospitality Director

Core Functions:

- Ushering and crowd management
- Visitor welcome and first-timer processing
- VIP and guest speaker protocol
- Service flow coordination (working with the Secretariat and Pastoral team)
- Venue setup and teardown

Sub-Units:

5a. Ushering

- Door ushers (greeting at entry)
- Floor ushers (seating, offering collection, altar call support)
- Parking coordination (when applicable)
- Crowd control and safety

5b. Protocol & Guest Relations

- VIP hosting
- Visiting minister coordination
- Platform management (who sits where, speaking order)
- Gift and honorarium coordination

5c. Events Planning & Coordination

- Annual event calendar execution
- Conference and retreat logistics
- Special services coordination (Easter, Christmas, conventions)
- Venue sourcing and negotiation

5d. Décor & Ambience

- Church interior styling
- Stage and altar design
- Seasonal decorations
- Event-specific theming

5e. Catering & Refreshments

- After-service refreshments (if applicable)

- Event catering coordination
- Love feast / fellowship meal planning

5f. Health & Safety

- First aid readiness
- Emergency response protocols
- Sanitation and hygiene
- COVID/health protocol compliance (as needed)

The 7-Minute Rule (Implement Immediately): Every first-timer must experience within their first 7 minutes:

1. A warm greeting at the door (with a smile and a handshake)
2. Assistance finding a seat
3. A welcome pack or card placed in their hand
4. A brief orientation ("Here's what to expect today")
5. Introduction to at least one friendly member nearby

Minimum Staffing to Launch: 1 Protocol Director + 4 Ushers + 1 Events Coordinator + 1 Décor Lead

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DEPARTMENT 6: PASTORAL CARE, WELFARE & FELLOWSHIP

"The Shepherd's Hand"

Scripture Foundation: "*Bear ye one another's burdens, and so fulfil the law of Christ*." — Galatians 6:2

Why This Exists: People don't leave churches because of bad sermons — they leave because nobody noticed they were hurting. This department ensures every member feels seen, known, and cared for. This is also where your RETENTION battle is won or lost.

Department Head Title: Pastoral Care Coordinator

Core Functions:

- Member welfare and support
- Hospital and home visitation
- Counseling referrals and coordination
- Bereavement support
- New member integration and follow-up
- Membership engagement monitoring

Sub-Units:

6a. Follow-Up & Integration (CRITICAL FOR YOUR 500 TARGET)

- First-timer follow-up calls (within 48 hours — NON-NEGOTIABLE)
- Second-visit follow-up (personal invitation back)
- Foundation School enrollment tracking
- Cell group placement
- 90-day new member journey management
- Absentee follow-up (anyone missing 2+ Sundays gets a call)

6b. Welfare & Benevolence

- Emergency financial assistance (with clear policy and limits)
- Food support for members in need
- Employment network (connecting members with job opportunities)
- Scholarship support coordination

6c. Counseling

- Pre-marital counseling coordination
- Marriage and family support
- Spiritual guidance referrals
- Grief and crisis support

6d. Fellowship Groups (Sub-Ministries) These are the community-building arms of the church:

- **Men of Valor (MOV)** — Men's fellowship, discipleship, accountability
- **Ladies of Faith (LOF)** — Women's fellowship, empowerment, prayer
- **Youth Ministry** — Ages 13-17 (teenagers)
- **Young Adults / Singles Ministry** — Ages 18-35
- **Couples & Family Ministry** — Married couples and families
- **Children's Ministry** — Ages 0-12 (Sunday School, Kids Church)
- **Sports & Recreation** — Fellowship through sports activities

6e. Fashion & Grooming (SMART Team)

- Dress code guidance for workers and leaders
- Corporate appearance for official events
- Uniform coordination for departments (ushers, choir, etc.)

The Retention Engine — The 90-Day New Member Journey:

Timeframe	Action	Responsible
Day 1 (Sunday)	First-timer card collected, welcome pack given	Ushering + Follow-Up
Day 2-3	Follow-up call or WhatsApp message	Follow-Up Team
Week 1	Personal invitation to midweek service or cell group	Follow-Up Team
Week 2	Second visit follow-up, Foundation School invitation	Follow-Up Team + Discipleship
Week 3-4	Foundation School enrollment	Discipleship Department
Month 2	Cell group placement	Cell Ministry
Month 2-3	Water baptism class	Pastoral Team
Month 3	Department placement conversation	Secretariat + Pastoral Care
Month 3	Official membership class	Pastoral Team

Minimum Staffing to Launch: 1 Pastoral Care Coordinator + 2 Follow-Up Officers + 1 Welfare Officer + Fellowship Group leads (as available)

DEPARTMENT 7: PRAYER & SPIRITUAL WARFARE

"The Engine Room"

Scripture Foundation: "*The effectual fervent prayer of a righteous man availeth much*." — James 5:16

Why This Exists: Everything rises and falls on prayer. Before there was a cell system at Christ Embassy, there was a prayer chain. Before Winners Chapel had 50,000 seats, they had all-night prayer meetings. This department fuels everything else with spiritual power.

Department Head Title: Prayer Coordinator / Intercessory Director

Core Functions:

- Organized intercessory prayer for church, leadership, members, and nation
- Pre-service prayer coordination
- Prayer chain management
- Special prayer programs (watch nights, prayer weeks, fasting programs)
- Prayer request collection and follow-up
- Altar worker training and coordination

Sub-Units:

7a. Intercessory Team

- Daily prayer chain (rotating members covering every day)
- Pre-service prayer (30-60 minutes before every service)
- Leadership prayer covering
- Emergency prayer mobilization

7b. Altar Ministry

- Altar call response team
- Prayer and laying on of hands during services
- Prophetic ministry coordination (under pastoral oversight)
- Testimony documentation

7c. Prayer Programs

- Monthly prayer nights / vigils
- Annual prayer and fasting programs
- Campus-wide prayer walks
- Online prayer meetings

Minimum Staffing to Launch: 1 Prayer Coordinator + 4-6 Intercessors + 2 Altar Workers

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PART TWO: DEPARTMENTS AT A GLANCE

#	Department	Head Title	Sub-Units	Launch Priority
1	Secretariat & Administration	Chief Admin Secretary	Database & Info, Communications	PHASE 1 — Immediate
2	Finance & Stewardship	Financial Secretary	Collections, Procurement, Wealth Teaching	PHASE 1 — Immediate
3	Worship, Music & Arts	Worship Director	Music, Creative Arts, Sound/Technical	PHASE 1 — Immediate
4	Media & Production	Media Director	Photo/Video, Social Media, Design, Publishing	PHASE 1 — Immediate
5	Hospitality, Protocol & Events	Protocol Director	Ushering, Protocol, Events, Décor, Catering, Health	PHASE 1 — Immediate
6	Pastoral Care, Welfare & Fellowship	Pastoral Care Coordinator	Follow-Up, Welfare, Counseling, Fellowship Groups, SMART	PHASE 2 — Within 60 Days

#	Department	Head Title	Sub-Units	Launch Priority
7	Prayer & Spiritual Warfare	Prayer Coordinator	Intercessory, Altar Ministry, Prayer Programs	PHASE 1 — Immediate

Total Sub-Units Across All Departments: 27

These 27 sub-units give you room to place and develop a large number of workers without creating unnecessary standalone departments. As the church grows past 200, 300, 500 members, key sub-units can be elevated to full departments.

PART THREE: THE DISCIPLESHIP RETENTION SYSTEM

"We Don't Just Win Them — We Keep Them"

This is your personal conviction, My Lord, and it must be systemized. Here is the complete discipleship pipeline:

The JCIM Discipleship Pathway

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STAGE 1: CONTACT
  First-time visitor → First-timer card → 48-hour follow-up
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STAGE 2: CONNECT
  Second visit → Cell group invitation → Midweek service
  ↓
STAGE 3: CULTIVATE
  Foundation School enrollment (18 Modules, Episterizo Methodology)
  ↓
STAGE 4: COMMIT
  Water baptism → Membership class → Official membership
  ↓
STAGE 5: CONTRIBUTE
  Department placement → Active service
  ↓
STAGE 6: CELL LEADERSHIP
  Cell member → Assistant cell leader → Cell leader
  ↓
STAGE 7: COMMISSION
  Zone leader → District pastor → Campus pastor → Ordained minister
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Tracking System

Every member should be trackable on this pipeline. At any given time, leadership should be able to answer:

- How many people are at each stage?

- Who has stalled and where?
- What is the average time from Stage 1 to Stage 4?
- What is the dropout rate between stages?

Recommended Tool: A simple Google Sheet or Airtable base with each member's name and their current stage, updated weekly by the Follow-Up team and Secretariat.

PART FOUR: PHASED IMPLEMENTATION ROADMAP

PHASE 1: FOUNDATION (Now — End of March 2026)

Theme: "Get the Engine Running"

- [ ] Appoint department heads for all 7 departments (even if they lead alone initially)
- [ ] Open a dedicated church bank account
- [ ] Set up a basic membership database (Google Sheet is fine to start)
- [ ] Establish the Sunday service operations flow (setup → service → teardown)
- [ ] Launch the 48-hour first-timer follow-up protocol
- [ ] Begin Foundation School with current members
- [ ] Create social media accounts and begin consistent posting
- [ ] Establish weekly prayer meeting
- [ ] Create a simple monthly budget
- [ ] Hold first all-leaders meeting to cast vision and assign roles

PHASE 2: STRUCTURE (April — June 2026)

Theme: "Build the Walls"

- [ ] All departments have at least 3 people each
- [ ] Cell groups launched (minimum 5 cells)
- [ ] Follow-up system fully operational with tracking
- [ ] Financial systems established (weekly counting, monthly reporting)
- [ ] Media producing weekly content consistently
- [ ] Foundation School running in cohorts
- [ ] Sub-ministries (MOV, LOF) begin meeting
- [ ] Monthly leaders meetings established
- [ ] First major outreach/evangelistic event
- [ ] Membership at 100-150

PHASE 3: ACCELERATION (July — September 2026)

Theme: "Open the Gates"

- [ ] Cell multiplication begins (each cell births a daughter cell)

- [ ] Major evangelistic campaigns (crusade, campus outreach, digital campaigns)
- [ ] Leadership Academy launched for cell leaders
- [ ] Financial self-sustainability approaching 70%+
- [ ] Second campus conversations begin (if applicable)
- [ ] Publishing first devotional/booklet for mass distribution
- [ ] Monthly prayer nights drawing external visitors
- [ ] Membership at 250-350

PHASE 4: ESTABLISHMENT (October — December 2026)

Theme: "Set the Stone"

- [ ] All 27 sub-units have identified leaders
- [ ] 500+ members with 70%+ actively engaged
- [ ] 20+ functioning cell groups
- [ ] Foundation School has graduated 3+ cohorts
- [ ] Financial systems mature with quarterly audits
- [ ] End-of-year convention / thanksgiving as flagship event
- [ ] Leadership pipeline producing new leaders consistently
- [ ] Full operational systems documented in SOPs
- [ ] Year-end report demonstrates ESTABLISHMENT

PART FIVE: THE PATH TO 500 — GROWTH MATH

To reach 500 members by December 2026 (approximately 10 months), here is the growth math:

If Starting With ~30-50 Core Members:

Quarter	Target	Monthly Growth Needed	Primary Growth Engine
Q1 (Mar)	80-100	+15-20/month	Personal invitation, social media, Foundation School
Q2 (Jun)	150-200	+20-30/month	Cell multiplication, first outreach event, media reach
Q3 (Sep)	300-350	+40-50/month	Crusade/campaign, cell multiplication compounding, digital evangelism
Q4 (Dec)	500+	+50-60/month	Compounding cells, word-of-mouth, major events, media visibility

The Cell Multiplication Math:

- Start with 5 cells of 10 people = 50 people
- Each cell multiplies once every 6 months
- By Month 6: 10 cells × 12 people = 120 people in cells
- By Month 10: 20 cells × 12 people = 240 people in cells
- Plus Sunday-only attendees + new converts not yet in cells = 500+ total

The cell system is your primary growth engine for hitting 500. Media brings visibility. Evangelism brings first-timers. But CELLS retain and multiply.

PART SIX: IMMEDIATE ACTION ITEMS — THE FIRST 14 DAYS

These are the non-negotiable actions for the next two weeks:

Day	Action	Owner
Day 1	Appoint 7 department heads (even provisionally)	General Overseer
Day 1	Open church bank account	General Overseer + Financial Secretary
Day 2	Create church membership Google Sheet	Secretariat Head
Day 3	Set up church social media accounts (if not existing)	Media Director
Day 3	Create first-timer welcome card template	Secretariat + Hospitality
Day 5	Hold first all-leaders meeting: cast vision, distribute this document	General Overseer
Day 7	First Sunday with new departmental structure active	All Department Heads
Day 7	First offering counted and recorded properly	Finance Team
Day 7	First-timer cards collected and filed	Follow-Up Team
Day 8-9	48-hour follow-up calls made to all first-timers	Follow-Up Team
Day 10	Social media posting schedule begins	Media Team
Day 10	Foundation School schedule announced	General Overseer
Day 12	First cell group meetings scheduled	Cell Leaders
Day 14	First weekly leaders check-in via WhatsApp or meeting	General Overseer

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CLOSING WORD

My Lord, this is not a document to read and shelve. This is your **operational constitution** for the Year of Establishment. Every department listed here serves one purpose: to create a system where people are won, kept, discipled, and released into purpose.

The 500 is not a fantasy — it is a mathematical and spiritual certainty IF the systems are built, the follow-up is relentless, the cells multiply, and the prayer engine never stops.

Christ Embassy was once a campus fellowship with a handful of students. Winners Chapel started in a small hall with 4 people. RHEMA Bible Church began as a training center, not a megachurch. Every great ministry started where you are right now — with a vision, a handful of committed people, and the willingness to build systems that outlast the builder.

"The LORD shall establish thee an holy people unto himself." — Deuteronomy 28:9

The establishment has begun.

Document prepared by The Kingdom Architect for JCIM/The Berean Church | Year of Establishment 2026